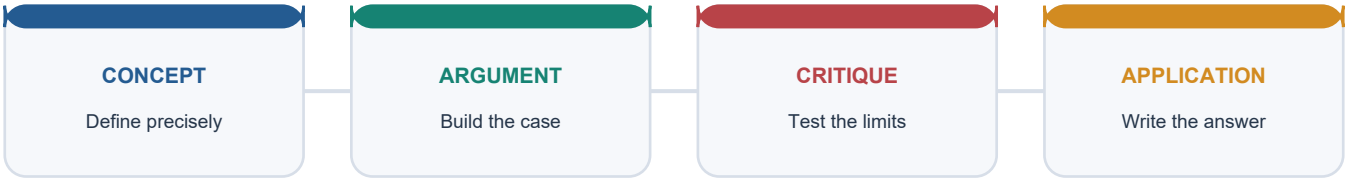
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

The Beginnings of European Settlements - Solved Practice Workbook

GS-I Modern Indian History | 32 solved MCQs, PYQs and Mains models

LEARNING PATH



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The Beginnings of European Settlements - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. The Portuguese Estado da India was best described as:

A. A dispersed Crown administrative-military network of forts, fleets and royal factories. B. A privately owned Portuguese joint-stock company identical to the VOC. C. A Mughal naval department headquartered at Goa. D. A modern nation-state with continuous Asian borders.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - the Estado was a Crown formation under a viceroy or governor; distance and local negotiation limited central control.
- **B.** Wrong - the Estado was a Crown institution, not a private joint-stock company like the VOC.
- **C.** Wrong - Goa was a Portuguese Crown headquarters, not a Mughal department.
- **D.** Wrong - no continuous Asian nation-state existed; the Estado was dispersed and Crown-administered.

Trap logic: 'Modern nation-state' language is the giveaway distractor for a dispersed early-modern Crown network.

Q2. Which chronology is correct?

A. Goa capital 1498 -> Calicut 1510 -> Cochin 1530. B. Calicut 1498 -> Goa capture 1510 -> Goa capital 1530. C. Goa capture 1505 -> Calicut 1510 -> capital 1661. D. Calicut 1510 -> Goa capital 1511 -> Goa capture 1530.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Goa did not become the capital in 1498, before contact with Calicut even occurred.
- **B.** Correct - Calicut 1498, Goa capture 1510, Goa capital 1530 is the verified order.
- **C.** Wrong - reverses the true order; Calicut (1498) preceded Goa's capture (1510).
- **D.** Wrong - places the 1511 capital before the 1510 capture, an impossible sequence.

Trap logic: Capture, capital-designation and later transfer dates are frequently scrambled; anchor each milestone separately.

Q3. Which combination is safely linked to Portuguese maritime networks?

A. Fort William and the Permanent Settlement. B. Pulicat and VOC spice monopoly. C. Goa printing press and the introduction of papaya, pineapple and guava. D. Pondicherry grid and Dupleix's governorship.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Fort William and the Permanent Settlement belong to the later English/Company period, not Portuguese networks.
- **B.** Wrong - Pulicat and the spice monopoly belong to Dutch, not Portuguese, networks.
- **C.** Correct - the Goa press (1556) and papaya, pineapple and guava transfers are Portuguese-linked and 2025-key confirmed.
- **D.** Wrong - Pondicherry and Dupleix belong to the French Compagnie, not Portuguese networks.

Trap logic: Cultural-transfer questions mix companies; verify the transfer is specifically Portuguese before selecting.

Q4. The VOC's 1602 charter is significant because it:

A. Transferred Goa from Bijapur. B. Made Pondicherry a French presidency. C. Issued the Mughal cartaz. D. Created a joint-stock corporation with extensive commercial and quasi-sovereign powers.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Goa was never transferred from Bijapur to the VOC; it remained Portuguese.
- **B.** Wrong - Pondicherry became a French, not Dutch, presidency.
- **C.** Wrong - the cartaz was a Portuguese instrument, not a VOC charter.
- **D.** Correct - the 1602 charter created a joint-stock corporation with commercial and quasi-sovereign powers, though enforcement still depended on local conditions.

Trap logic: A charter's legal powers are not the same as guaranteed enforcement on the ground.

Q5. What does Colachel 1741 demonstrate?

A. An Indian regional state, Travancore, could defeat a European company force. B. The Portuguese captured Madras from the French. C. The EIC received the 1717 farman. D. The Dutch conquered Bengal territorially.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - Travancore's 1741 victory over the VOC is strong anti-teleological evidence of Indian military capacity.
- **B.** Wrong - the Portuguese did not capture Madras from the French; this conflates unrelated actors.
- **C.** Wrong - the 1717 farman was an EIC-Mughal matter, unconnected to Colachel.
- **D.** Wrong - the Dutch did not territorially conquer Bengal at Colachel or elsewhere in this period.

Trap logic: A single Indian victory is strong anti-teleological evidence, not proof of total European withdrawal.

Q6. The naval encounter at Swally in 1612 mattered because it:

A. Made the EIC emperor of Gujarat. B. Improved English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence. C. Created the French company. D. Ended all Portuguese trade in Asia.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Swally improved English standing; it did not make the EIC ruler of Gujarat.
- **B.** Correct - Swally raised English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence, without transferring sovereignty.
- **C.** Wrong - Swally involved the English and Portuguese, not the founding of a French company.
- **D.** Wrong - Portuguese trade in Asia continued after Swally; it was not ended.

Trap logic: A naval encounter changing 'credibility' is not the same as a naval encounter changing sovereignty.

Q7. Which sequence best describes the English Coromandel chain?

A. Surat charter -> Chandernagore -> Diu. B. Bombay lease -> Goa capture -> Pulicat. C. Masulipatnam factory -> Madras lease -> Fort St George. D. Pondicherry -> Calcutta -> Cochin.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Surat, Chandernagore and Diu belong to different companies and coasts, not the Coromandel chain.
- **B.** Wrong - Bombay, Goa and Pulicat mix English, Portuguese and Dutch sites out of sequence.
- **C.** Correct - Masulipatnam preceded the 1639 Madras lease and fortification from 1640.
- **D.** Wrong - Pondicherry, Calcutta and Cochin belong to French/English/Portuguese networks respectively, not one Coromandel sequence.

Trap logic: Keep the Coromandel sequence isolated from Bombay, Portuguese and French place-names.

Q8. Which Bombay chronology is correct?

A. Job Charnock founded Bombay in 1690. B. EIC conquest in 1600 -> Mughal farman in 1613. C. French purchase in 1664 -> Dutch transfer in 1668. D. Portuguese possession -> English Crown in 1661 -> EIC in 1668.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Job Charnock is linked to Calcutta, not Bombay's 1690 founding.
- **B.** Wrong - the EIC did not conquer Bombay in 1600; the farman/charter dates are separate matters.
- **C.** Wrong - there was no French purchase or Dutch transfer of Bombay at these dates.
- **D.** Correct - Portuguese possession, English Crown acquisition in 1661, then EIC lease in 1668 is the verified sequence.

Trap logic: Bombay's Portuguese-to-Crown-to-Company chain is a standard factual trap against Calcutta-style narratives.

Q9. What did Child's War reveal?

A. The Mughal state could defeat and discipline the EIC, which returned as a petitioner. B. The Dutch captured Goa. C. The French defeated Travancore. D. The EIC was territorially supreme by 1686.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - the Mughal state disciplined the EIC, which returned as a petitioner, disproving inevitable Company dominance.
- **B.** Wrong - the Dutch did not capture Goa during Child's War; this misattributes the episode.
- **C.** Wrong - the French and Travancore are unrelated to this specifically Mughal-EIC conflict.
- **D.** Wrong - the EIC was defeated and had to submit, so it was not territorially supreme by 1686.

Trap logic: Child's War is proof against inevitable Company dominance, not evidence of early EIC supremacy.

Q10. A presidency was principally:

A. A Portuguese maritime pass. B. A regional council system coordinating factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence. C. A Mughal revenue-free village. D. A Jesuit religious order.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - a Portuguese maritime pass is the cartaz, a distinct institution.
- **B.** Correct - a presidency coordinated factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence across a region without automatically creating sovereignty.
- **C.** Wrong - a presidency was a company coordinating body, not a Mughal revenue-free village.
- **D.** Wrong - a presidency was administrative-commercial, not a Jesuit religious order.

Trap logic: Coordination and administrative status do not by themselves create territorial sovereignty.

Q11. Dupleix is relevant to this topic mainly as:

A. The conqueror of Goa in 1510. B. The issuer of the 1717 farman. C. A bridge from commercial settlements to intervention in Indian succession politics. D. The founder of the VOC.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Dupleix governed decades after 1510 and had no role in Goa's capture.
- **B.** Wrong - the 1717 farman was an EIC-Mughal document, unrelated to Dupleix.
- **C.** Correct - Dupleix bridges commercial settlement to intervention in Indian succession politics, chiefly through the Carnatic Wars.
- **D.** Wrong - Dupleix served the French Compagnie, not the Dutch VOC, and did not found it.

Trap logic: Detailed Carnatic War chronology is bounded; the exam-relevant point is Dupleix's bridging mechanism.

Q12. Which comparison is accurate?

A. All four began as Indian farmans. B. All four were identical private firms. C. Only the Portuguese had any public power. D. Portuguese Crown Estado; Dutch VOC; English EIC; French state-sponsored Compagnie.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - none of the four companies began as an Indian farman; farmans were grants received by companies, not their origin.
- **B.** Wrong - the four differed in ownership and state backing; they were not identical private firms.
- **C.** Wrong - the VOC and EIC also held delegated public/quasi-sovereign powers, not only the Portuguese.
- **D.** Correct - Portuguese Crown Estado, Dutch VOC, English EIC and French state-sponsored Compagnie are institutionally distinct forms.

Trap logic: Institutional form differences do not mechanically determine strategic outcome.

Q13. Dubashes and brokers were important because they:

A. Connected language, procurement, credit, customs and political access. B. Replaced all Indian merchants. C. Issued Mughal farmans independently. D. Commanded the Portuguese Crown in Lisbon.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - dubashes and brokers connected language, procurement, credit, customs and political access for companies.
- **B.** Wrong - brokers supplemented, not replaced, the wider Indian merchant community.
- **C.** Wrong - farmans were sovereign Mughal instruments; brokers had no independent authority to issue them.
- **D.** Wrong - dubashes worked at Indian ports, not in command of the Portuguese Crown in Lisbon.

Trap logic: Intermediaries had real leverage; do not reduce them to passive company employees.

Q14. Which regional commodity pairing is safest?

A. Coromandel - no textiles. B. Bengal - cottons, silk and access to Bihar saltpetre. C. Malabar - only silver mines. D. Surat - exclusively tea.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Coromandel was a major textile-producing region, not a 'no textiles' zone.
- **B.** Correct - Bengal is safely paired with cottons, silk and access to Bihar saltpetre.
- **C.** Wrong - Malabar's trade was built on pepper and spices, not exclusively silver mines.

- **D.** Wrong - Surat handled a range of goods, not exclusively tea.

Trap logic: Regional commodity pairings should link port to hinterland, not claim exclusivity.

Q15. European port settlements should be understood as:

A. Uniform cities built from one metropolitan plan. B. Pure military camps without trade. C. Layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves. D. Self-sufficient European islands with no hinterland links.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - settlements varied by site and period; they were not uniform cities from one metropolitan plan.
- **B.** Wrong - settlements combined trade and habitation; they were not pure military camps.
- **C.** Correct - port settlements were layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves.
- **D.** Wrong - settlements were not self-sufficient; they depended on hinterland links.

Trap logic: Fortified walls separated legal jurisdiction more than they separated economic life from the hinterland.

Q16. Which site-style pairing is accurate?

A. Calcutta - Portuguese Estado capital. B. Pulicat - Mughal capital. C. Bombay - Jesuit headquarters from 1498. D. Old Goa - Indo-Portuguese church ensemble; Pondicherry - French grid tradition.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Calcutta was an English EIC settlement, not a Portuguese Estado capital.
- **B.** Wrong - Pulicat was a Dutch coastal base, not a Mughal capital.
- **C.** Wrong - Bombay was not a Jesuit headquarters from 1498; that period predates Portuguese arrival in Bombay.
- **D.** Correct - Old Goa's Indo-Portuguese church ensemble and Pondicherry's French grid tradition are accurately paired material-heritage examples.

Trap logic: Heritage-site pairings must match the correct company and period, not just a plausible-sounding name.

Q17. Which Portuguese fort on the Malabar coast did the Dutch capture in 1663?

A. Cochin. B. Diu. C. Daman. D. Goa.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - the Dutch captured Cochin from the Portuguese in 1663, consolidating control of the Malabar pepper trade.
- **B.** Wrong - Diu remained under Portuguese control and was never taken by the Dutch.
- **C.** Wrong - Daman likewise stayed Portuguese; it was not a Dutch conquest.
- **D.** Wrong - Goa, the Estado's capital, was never captured by the Dutch despite repeated blockades.

Trap logic: Candidates confuse Dutch pressure on Portuguese Goa (blockades that failed) with the Dutch capture of Cochin, which did succeed and is the historically correct pairing.

Q18. Which factor belongs to the later multiplier, not the original English foothold?

A. The 1600 charter. B. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani. C. Surat permission. D. The 1639 Madras lease.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - the 1600 charter predates and enables, rather than results from, later expansion.
- **B.** Correct - Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani is the later multiplier, not the original foothold.
- **C.** Wrong - Surat permission belongs to the original seventeenth-century foothold, not the later multiplier.
- **D.** Wrong - the 1639 Madras lease is also part of the original foothold period.

Trap logic: Separate the original seventeenth-century foothold from the later Bengal-revenue multiplier after Plassey.

Q19. Which chronological order is correct?

A. VOC 1498 -> EIC 1510 -> Surat 1664 -> Madras 1717. B. French company 1498 -> EIC 1505 -> VOC 1510 -> Bombay 1530. C. EIC charter 1600 -> VOC 1602 -> Surat factory 1613 -> Madras 1639. D. Madras 1600 -> Surat 1602 -> Goa 1613 -> Calicut 1639.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - the VOC was not founded in 1498; this misplaces its charter date.
- **B.** Wrong - the French company and EIC dates given here are out of sequence and unverified.
- **C.** Correct - EIC charter 1600, VOC 1602, Surat factory 1613, Madras 1639 is the verified recall ladder.
- **D.** Wrong - Madras 1600 and Surat 1602 reverse the true chronology of these sites.

Trap logic: The 1600/1602/1613/1639 recall ladder is a core chronology; do not let charter and factory dates collapse together.

Q20. Which statement is correct about a factory?

A. It automatically collected land revenue. B. It always manufactured textiles. C. It was identical to a presidency. D. It was a commercial depot and could exist without fortification.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - a factory did not automatically collect land revenue; that required a separate grant.
- **B.** Wrong - a factory did not always manufacture textiles; many were trading depots only.
- **C.** Wrong - a factory and a presidency were distinct administrative levels, not identical.
- **D.** Correct - a factory was a commercial depot and could exist without fortification.

Trap logic: A factory's core feature is commercial depot function, independent of fortification, revenue or manufacturing.

Q21. What did the 1717 farman not do?

A. Charter the EIC in England. B. Create later customs disputes. C. Support Company claims around Calcutta. D. Expand Bengal privileges.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - the EIC charter dates to 1600, so the 1717 farman did not charter the EIC in England.
- **B.** Wrong - the farman's ambiguity in fact created later customs disputes.
- **C.** Wrong - the farman did support Company claims connected to the Calcutta area.
- **D.** Wrong - the farman did expand Bengal-related privileges.

Trap logic: The 1717 farman expanded privilege; the EIC's own charter is a separate, earlier (1600) instrument.

Q22. How does Tranquebar fit alongside the Dutch in the four/five-power comparison?

A. Tranquebar was a Dutch fort captured from Portugal. B. Tranquebar was the Danish East India Company's settlement (from 1620) - a minor presence of low political significance beside the Portuguese, Dutch, English and French. C. Tranquebar was the VOC's headquarters for its Indonesia trade. D. Tranquebar was ceded to the EIC in 1668.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Tranquebar was Danish, not Dutch, and was never a captured Portuguese fort.
- **B.** Correct - Tranquebar was the Danish East India Company's settlement, remaining commercially and politically minor throughout.
- **C.** Wrong - the VOC's Indonesian headquarters was Batavia, not Tranquebar.
- **D.** Wrong - the 1668 Crown-to-Company transfer concerned Bombay, not Tranquebar.

Trap logic: Candidates fold every minor coastal settlement into the four main rivals; Tranquebar is the standing counter-example of a fifth, politically marginal European presence.

Q23. Which site pairing is correct?

A. Pulicat - Portuguese; Pondicherry - English. B. Pulicat - French; Pondicherry - Dutch. C. Pulicat - Dutch; Pondicherry - French. D. Both were Mughal capitals.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Pulicat was Dutch, not Portuguese, and Pondicherry was French, not English.
- **B.** Wrong - this reverses the true company attributions for both sites.
- **C.** Correct - Pulicat is Dutch and Pondicherry is French, an accurate site-company pairing.
- **D.** Wrong - neither Pulicat nor Pondicherry was a Mughal capital.

Trap logic: Site-company pairings are easy points; do not let similar-sounding options cause a careless swap.

Q24. Fortification should be treated as:

A. A purely religious institution. B. Proof of complete inland sovereignty. C. A synonym for charter. D. A contingent step requiring resources and political tolerance, not automatic empire.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - forts were military-commercial, not purely religious institutions.
- **B.** Wrong - fortification did not prove complete inland sovereignty; hinterlands stayed politically negotiated.
- **C.** Wrong - a fort and a charter are distinct instruments, not synonyms.
- **D.** Correct - fortification was a contingent step requiring resources and political tolerance, not automatic empire.

Trap logic: A fort requiring host-ruler tolerance is not proof of inland sovereignty.

Q25. What is the safest description of mercantilism in this topic?

A. It linked chartered monopoly, protected commerce, naval force and state-company privilege. B. It meant that Asian merchants ceased trading after 1498. C. It prohibited every form of private trade by company servants. D. It separated commerce completely from diplomacy and war.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - mercantilism linked chartered monopoly, protected commerce, naval force and state-company privilege.
- **B.** Wrong - Asian merchants continued trading vigorously after 1498, not ceasing.

- **C.** Wrong - company servants often conducted private trade alongside official monopoly commerce.
- **D.** Wrong - mercantilism linked, rather than separated, commerce from diplomacy and war.

Trap logic: Mercantilism is a linked bundle of monopoly, force and privilege, not a separation of commerce from the state.

Q26. Which statement correctly links St Francis Xavier to Goa?

A. He introduced a precisely dated crop package in a single year. B. He worked from Goa, was a founding Jesuit companion, died off China and has his tomb at Bom Jesus. C. He founded the Jesuit Order alone and died in Goa. D. He commanded the Portuguese cartaz fleet from Diu.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - his crop-transfer role is unrelated; this option confuses Xavier with agricultural transfer questions.
- **B.** Correct - he worked from Goa, was a founding Jesuit companion, died off China and his tomb is at Bom Jesus.
- **C.** Wrong - Xavier was a founding companion, not sole founder, of the Jesuit Order, and he died off China, not in Goa.
- **D.** Wrong - Xavier was a missionary, not a commander of the Portuguese cartaz fleet.

Trap logic: Death-site, burial-site and 'founding companion' status must each be verified separately for Xavier.

Q27. What administrative change took place at Bombay in 1687?

A. Bombay reverted to Portuguese control. B. The Third Carnatic War ended there. C. The EIC shifted its west-coast presidency headquarters from Surat to Bombay. D. Bombay received the Diwani of Bengal.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Bombay had already passed by Crown lease to the Company; it did not revert to Portugal.
- **B.** Wrong - the Third Carnatic War is a much later Anglo-French conflict, unconnected to this 1687 administrative shift.
- **C.** Correct - in 1687 the Company moved its west-coast presidency headquarters from Surat to Bombay, reflecting Bombay's growing administrative weight.
- **D.** Wrong - the Diwani of Bengal came in 1765 and is unrelated to Bombay's 1687 status.

Trap logic: Do not confuse the 1687 Surat-to-Bombay administrative shift with the earlier Crown-to-Company property transfer of 1661/1668 - one is a title change, the other an internal headquarters decision.

Q28. Why is Job Charnock best handled cautiously?

A. He issued the 1717 farman as Mughal emperor. B. He commanded the French at Wandiwash. C. He founded Bombay after conquering it from Portugal. D. The conventional 1690 association is useful, but Calcutta grew cumulatively from existing villages and actors.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - the 1717 farman was issued by Farrukhsiyar, not by Charnock.
- **B.** Wrong - Charnock is linked to Calcutta and the EIC, not the French at Wandiwash.
- **C.** Wrong - Bombay came to the EIC via Portugal-to-Crown-to-Company transfer, not through Charnock's conquest.
- **D.** Correct - the conventional 1690 association is useful, but Calcutta grew cumulatively from existing villages and actors.

Trap logic: A convenient founding date does not mean a single-founder origin story; Calcutta's growth was cumulative.

Q29. What transformed the Carnatic Wars from imported European conflict into Indian politics?

A. European war intersected with Carnatic and Hyderabad claimant struggles and company-backed military service. B. The Portuguese cartaz decided every Carnatic succession. C. The wars began only after the Company received the Bengal Diwani. D. Indian rulers played no part in choosing allies.

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct - European rivalry intersected with Carnatic and Hyderabad succession struggles and company-backed military service.
- **B.** Wrong - the cartaz was a Portuguese maritime instrument, unconnected to Carnatic succession politics.
- **C.** Wrong - the Carnatic Wars began well before the Bengal Diwani grant of 1765.
- **D.** Wrong - Indian rulers actively chose sides and allies in the Carnatic conflicts.

Trap logic: European war and Indian succession politics fused; neither explains the Carnatic Wars alone.

Q30. Why is Wandiwash a bounded conclusion rather than this chapter's starting point?

A. It explains the original Mughal permission for Surat. B. It concludes the Anglo-French political rivalry after the earlier settlement and institutional story has been established. C. It was the first Portuguese landing on the Malabar coast. D. It created the Dutch VOC.

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Wandiwash (1760) followed, rather than explained, the earlier Mughal permission for Surat.
- **B.** Correct - Wandiwash concludes the Anglo-French political rivalry after the earlier settlement and institutional story has been established.
- **C.** Wrong - the first Portuguese Malabar landing came over two and a half centuries earlier.
- **D.** Wrong - the Dutch VOC was created by charter in 1602, unrelated to Wandiwash.

Trap logic: Wandiwash closes a rivalry thread already built on the earlier settlement story; it does not open it.

Q31. Which PYQ distinction correctly identifies Broach?

A. Broach was a Dutch spice-island capital. B. Broach was the Portuguese name for Fort St George. C. Broach belonged to the early Surat-centred EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century. D. Broach was the principal French base under Dupleix.

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - Broach was an EIC site, not a Dutch spice-island capital.
- **B.** Wrong - Broach and Fort St George are distinct English/Portuguese-unrelated sites.
- **C.** Correct - Broach belonged to the early Surat-centred EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century.
- **D.** Wrong - Broach was not a French base; Dupleix operated from Pondicherry.

Trap logic: Keep Broach fixed to the Surat-centred EIC network and the correct time window.

Q32. Which conclusion respects this chapter's boundary with the Bengal-conquest chapter?

A. This chapter should duplicate the whole Dual Government narrative. B. The 1717 farman should be treated as the Diwani grant. C. The Treaty of Paris made the Company Nawab of Bengal. D. European settlement and rivalry end with the Carnatic comparison; detailed Plassey and Buxar mechanics follow in the Bengal-conquest chapter.

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong - duplicating the Dual Government narrative here would blur, rather than respect, this chapter's boundary with the Bengal-conquest chapter.
- **B.** Wrong - the 1717 farman expanded privileges; it was not the Diwani grant, which came later in 1765.
- **C.** Wrong - the Treaty of Paris (1763) resolved Anglo-French rivalry; it did not make the Company Nawab of Bengal.
- **D.** Correct - European settlement and rivalry conclude with the Carnatic comparison; Plassey and Buxar mechanics belong to the Bengal-conquest chapter.

Trap logic: This chapter ends at the Carnatic comparison; Plassey/Buxar/Dual-Government mechanics belong strictly to the Bengal-conquest chapter.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified objective-demand boundary

Four direct Prelims demands are retained. The official 2025 Set-A key is available locally. The 2021 and 2022 items are analysed statement by statement without presenting an unsupported answer letter as official. The 2022 GS-I Mains item is an adjacent bridge whose full ownership lies in the territorial-expansion chapter. No direct 2026 question exists for this chapter.

PYQ 01 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q33: first-quarter EIC factories

- Question: In the first quarter of the seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located? 1. Broach 2. Chicacole 3. Trichinopoly. Options: (A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 (C) 3 only (D) 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Broach belonged to the early western factory network alongside Surat, Ahmedabad and Agra. Chicacole and Trichinopoly were not EIC factories in the specified first-quarter window. The elimination depends on time and institutional geography, not merely knowing later British centres.

PYQ 02 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q39: St Francis Xavier

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. St Francis Xavier was one of the founding members of the Jesuit Order. 2. He died in Goa and a church is dedicated to him there. 3. His feast is celebrated in Goa each year. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is correct: Xavier was among the founding companions of the Society of Jesus. Statement 2 is false because he died in 1552 on Shangchuan Island off China, although his remains are preserved in Goa. Statement 3 is correct; the feast is celebrated annually in Goa.

PYQ 03 - UPSC Prelims 2022 Q59: Dutch, Portuguese and English settlements

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. The Dutch established factories/warehouses on the east coast on lands granted by Gajapati rulers. 2. Albuquerque captured Goa from the Bijapur Sultanate. 3. The EIC established a factory at Madras on land leased from a representative of the Vijayanagara empire. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is incorrect: Pulicat and other Dutch east-coast bases are not safely attributed to grants by Gajapati rulers. Statement 2 is correct: Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510. Statement 3 is correct: the Madras lease came through a local Nayak authority linked to the Chandragiri/Vijayanagara political order.

PYQ 04 - UPSC Prelims 2025 Q75: Portuguese crop transfers

- Question: How many of papaya, pineapple and guava were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries? Options: (A) Only one (B) Only two (C) All three (D) None.
- OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C, all three. UPSC Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination 2025, GS-I, Series A official key.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Papaya, pineapple and guava were all introduced through Portuguese maritime networks. The safe formulation is the official question's broad sixteenth-seventeenth-century window; do not assign an unsupported single year to each crop.

PYQ 05 - Adjacent bridge: UPSC GS-I Mains 2022 Q2

- Question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising of Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (150 words, 10 marks)
- VERIFIED QUESTION TEXT FROM LOCAL OFFICIAL 2022 GS-I PAPER. Included as a bounded bridge; its full ownership lies in the territorial-expansion chapter.
- Solved explanation / model answer: The Company converted a commercial network into a fiscal-military system. Presidency coordination joined Madras, Bombay and Bengal to oceanic reinforcement; standard drill, artillery organisation and regular cash payment sustained sepoy units. Named evidence includes Fort St George as an early garrison hub, Bengal revenue after the 1765 Diwani, and Indian bankers, suppliers and soldiers who enabled campaigning. By contrast, many rulers faced fragmented command, irregular payment, rival claimants and weak inter-state coordination. Yet defeat was not inevitable: Mysore checked the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War, Travancore defeated the Dutch at Colachel and the Marathas forced the Treaty of Salbai. The decisive advantage was therefore not European ethnicity or weapon ownership but the Company's integration of finance, logistics, naval mobility, command and Indian alliances over repeated wars.

Original Mains 10M-1

Question: Distinguish maritime exploration, trading presence, fortified settlement and territorial empire. (150 words)

Model answer (99 words): These are cumulative, non-identical forms of power; confusing them makes conquest appear inevitable. Vasco da Gama's 1498 Calicut voyage opened direct Portuguese sea contact; it changed routes and bargaining, not jurisdiction. Surat (1613) was an EIC factory under Mughal permission, a warehouse-office-residence, not a manufacturing plant or province. Fort St George, after the 1639 Madras lease, protected stock, specie and staff, but its hinterland stayed politically negotiated. Territorial empire needed revenue, army, alliances and victory; Bengal's post-1757 fiscal turn is later and cannot explain the 1600 charter. The stages show expanding capability, not an automatic legal or causal sequence.

Original Mains 10M-2

Question: European settlements were co-produced by Indian agency. Explain. (150 words)

Model answer (125 words): European companies supplied ships, capital and guns, but Indian rulers and port societies determined access, supply and political survival. Rulers: the Zamorin resisted Portuguese monopoly; Cochin allied with Portugal; Jahangir's government permitted Surat after English naval credibility; a Nayak grant enabled Madras; Aurangzeb defeated the EIC in Child's War. Merchants and brokers: Virji Vohra, Armenian networks and dubashes supplied credit, information, procurement and customs mediation, and could support, constrain or redirect a company. Producers and labour: Coromandel and Bengal weavers, shipbuilders, transporters and food suppliers made factories viable; fort walls never removed dependence on the surrounding town. Agency operated within growing naval and corporate asymmetry; collaboration did not mean equal power. Before conquest, the settlement was a negotiated institution embedded in Indian sovereignty and economy.

Original Mains 15M-1

Question: Explain why Dutch India remained commercially important but territorially secondary. (250 words)

Model answer (175 words): Dutch strategy did not neglect India; it assigned Indian ports a commercial role inside an Indonesia-centred monopoly portfolio. The VOC charter of 1602 pooled capital and granted treaty, war and fortification powers. This made it a formidable company-state but did not dictate where it should conquer. Pulicat and later Nagapattinam connected Coromandel textiles to intra-Asian trade; Surat linked Gujarat and West Asia; Chinsura and Bengal supplied silk, textiles and saltpetre. Indian cloth purchased Southeast Asian spices, so India was essential to VOC circulation. Monopoly profits were concentrated in the Indonesian archipelago. Large Indian territorial commitments promised heavy military and political cost without the same monopoly logic. Nayaks, Mughal officials, merchants and weavers fixed land, customs and supply. Travancore's victory at Colachel in 1741 proved a regional state could defeat Dutch arms without ending Dutch commerce. Amboyna 1623 sharpened English-Dutch rivalry, while Bedara 1759 marked a later Bengal check. Yet Dutch factories survived; commercial contraction and political retreat were not identical. The Dutch outcome followed portfolio choice, local resistance and English competition, not simple commercial failure.

Original Mains 15M-2

Question: Assess the cultural and material effects of the Portuguese presence in India. (250 words)

Model answer (173 words): Portuguese influence outlasted their commercial primacy because maritime, missionary and urban institutions moved plants, print, religious practices and architectural forms; effects were creative and coercive. Francis Xavier reached Goa in 1542 as a founding Jesuit; his remains at Bom Jesus became a lasting devotional centre. Mission schools and orders institutionalised Catholic presence. Yet the Goa Inquisition from 1560 and coercive policy require a power-sensitive account. The Goa press of 1556, conventionally India's first, linked movable type to missionary education and language work. Its significance was institutional diffusion, not immediate mass literacy. The official 2025 UPSC key confirms papaya, pineapple and guava as Portuguese introductions in the sixteenth-seventeenth centuries. Chronologies for individual crops should not be over-specified. ASI/UNESCO identify Old Goa's churches, including Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral, as major ensembles. European forms were adapted by local materials and artisans; mixed communities and maritime vocabulary also developed. Influence varied by region and did not erase existing cultures. Missions, trade, intermarriage, local patronage and resistance worked simultaneously. Portuguese decline was territorial-commercial, not cultural disappearance.

Original Mains 20M-1

Question: Why did the English eventually gain relative advantage over the Portuguese, Dutch and French? Reject monocausal and teleological explanations. (250 words)

Model answer (185 words): English advantage emerged from a contingent bundle: finance, navy, diversified bases, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing, rather than an innate national superiority or destiny fixed in 1600. Shareholder capital, London credit, private trade and later the English fiscal-naval state sustained repeated voyages and war. Yet the EIC remained dependent on royal charter and naval protection; it was not purely private. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities and risk. Bombay's harbour, Fort St George's council and Bengal's textile-credit depth created mutually supporting nodes. The Portuguese Estado was overextended and

resource-thin; VOC strategy rationally prioritised Indonesia; French India faced discontinuous naval-financial support and stronger home-state interference. These were strategic constraints, not stereotypes. Mughal permissions, Nayak leases, merchants, bankers, dubashes, sepoys and suppliers enabled English growth. Child's War and Indian victories such as Colachel prove that European triumph was never automatic. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani later financed war, but cannot explain seventeenth-century footholds. It was a multiplier after political breakthrough. The EIC gained relative advantage because it learned, survived reverses and connected corporate and state resources to Indian political openings more consistently than rivals.

Original Mains 20M-2

Question: Compare the political structures and business models of the four major European powers in India. (250 words)

Model answer (189 words): Institutional design shaped strategic options, but outcomes arose only when design interacted with geography, home-state priorities and Indian politics. The Estado da India was a Crown network of viceroy, fleets, forts and royal factories. Cartaz coercion suited chokepoints, but monopoly rigidity, thin resources and religious conflict limited adaptation. The 1602 VOC was a heavily capitalised joint-stock company with quasi-sovereign powers. Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat and Bengal supplied textiles and bulk goods to an Indonesia-first intra-Asian portfolio; India remained commercial rather than territorial priority. The 1600 EIC joined shareholder finance, private trade and a growing presidency system. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Calcutta produced a diversified network, though all early bases rested on permission, lease or transfer. The 1664 Compagnie des Indes combined monopoly trade with close royal sponsorship. Pondicherry and Chandernagore became capable hubs; Dupleix exploited claimant politics, but finance and naval support were less continuous. 'Private versus state' is too crude: every company used public power and every company contained private interest. Indian rulers and merchants mediated all four. The English model proved relatively resilient, not universally superior; Dutch Indonesian success and Portuguese cultural durability require different measures of outcome.